

nicole simmons.

M.Ed. · Educational
Leadership

Designing learning
experiences that drive
results.

CONTACT

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CREDENTIALS

M.Ed. · Educational Leadership
California Multiple Subject +
Admin Services
South Carolina K–12 credentialed

CORE CAPABILITIES

- Curriculum & learning experience design
- Performance improvement at scale
- AI-enabled diagnostic & tool design
- Coaching & capability building
- Stakeholder & executive communication
- Program management & founding teams
- Systems thinking · structural coherence
- Cross-functional leadership

15+
Years K–12
leadership

2
Founding-team
schools

3
Published research
papers

4+
Live AI tools
shipped

K–12 instructional leader and learning designer with 15+ years of measurable outcomes — Title I and private, classroom and district office. Inaugural Assistant Principal at a *California Distinguished School*. Founded ForwardEd Consulting (independent K–12 publishing & AI-tool practice). Transitioning into L&D, ed tech, and consulting roles where measurable outcomes, structural thinking, and AI fluency matter.

SELECTED EXPERIENCE

Inaugural Assistant Principal 2023 – 2025
Kathryn Newport Middle School · Title I MS (~1,000 students) · Menifee, CA

- Built data-driven PLC operating system + PDSA cycles across grade-level and content teams. **10–15% gain in single year**; 65%+ improved in ELA and Math; +6.6 on CAST. Direct contribution to **California Distinguished School recognition**.
- Operated Teacher Clarity Walkthrough protocol as admin team. **Y1 → Y2: ELA +5.2% · Math +11% · Science +15%**; 8th Math nearly doubled (18% → 36%). Subsequently built the live tool at *forwardedclarity.netlify.app*.
- Delivered 1:1 coaching + group PD cycles anchored to walkthrough data; led admin-team PD on NGSS adoption; designed reusable curriculum scaffolds adopted across grade levels.

Founder · Independent Practice 2026 – present
ForwardEd Consulting · K–12 publishing & AI-tool development

- Built and shipped **Cohesion Baseline** — AI-powered district diagnostic on Anthropic API + Netlify edge functions. 7 research-grounded dimensions, 995 CA districts pre-loaded. In pilot with TVUSD.
- Published **three research-grounded white papers** and a research-cited MTSS Intervention Framework (Field Guide + placemat + companion docs). All CC-licensed.

Director · Tech Trek STEM Camp 2014 – 2016
American Association of University Women · Whittier College · Residential MS program

- Redesigned curriculum, schedule, and program arc end-to-end. **Doubled enrollment** across the directorship; 90 girls per cohort; staff of 20; added a culminating Final Presentation arc and college-level lab experiences.

Inaugural Staff · Curriculum Designer 2011 – 2014
DISCOVER Academy · Sequoia MS, Newbury Park, CA · CSUCI partnership

- Founding-team launch of a "school within a school" Academy of Engineering and Applied Sciences. Collaborated with CSU Channel Islands on theme-based cross-curricular units; led MS Science Curriculum Design Team.

EARLIER ROLES

- TOSA — Teacher on Special Assignment** · Temecula Valley USD · Instructional support, NGSS-aligned implementation, science focus.
- Instructional Coach & Classroom Teacher** · Title I and private schools, California · 1:1 and team coaching, curriculum design, data cycles.
- Selected speaking**: App-Smashing workshop, Google Bootcamp Riverside County · ForwardEd publications.